

September

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A flying tank?

The Soviet Union claimed to have carried out the first test flight of a flying tank called the Antonov A-40. Designers hoped that it could be dropped from an aircraft and glide down onto the battlefield.

1942

Born this day

1948 Christa McAuliffe, US teacher and astronaut. She was the first teacher chosen to travel to space, but died when the Space Shuttle *Challenger* exploded after take-off.

1964 Keanu Reeves, Canadian actor. He rose to fame with starring roles in films such as *Bill & Ted's Excellent Adventure*, *Speed*, and *The Matrix*.

31 BCE Battle of Actium

In a naval battle off the coast of Actium, Greece, Roman leader Octavian defeated the joint forces of his rival Mark Antony and Queen Cleopatra of Egypt. Renaming himself Augustus, he soon took charge of the Roman Empire.



Space toys

The first Danish astronaut to go to space, Andreas Mogensen, took 20 LEGO® figurines to the International Space Station (ISS), to be awarded as a competition prize to schoolchildren at the end of his mission.

2015



Also on this day

1666 The Great Fire of London began at a bakery. It destroyed most of the city before it was put out.

1945 Vietnam declared its freedom from French colonial rule, after defeating the occupying Japanese forces at the end of World War II.

2013 US swimmer Diana Nyad became the first person to cross the shark-infested waters between Cuba and Florida, USA, without a shark cage for protection.